Fire on the Mountain

1 Kings 12 · 1 Kings 16:29–18:46

The big idea: After Solomon, the kingdom split, and the north began with golden calves. Ahab and Jezebel brought Baal into Israel. On Mount Carmel, Baal could not answer, and the LORD answered by fire. The people cried, "The LORD, he is God."

Before you meet: Read

1 Kings 12:25–33 | 1 Kings 17:1–7 | 1 Kings 18:17–39

Open (5 minutes)

What do people around you look to for security and success?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Behold your _____, O Israel, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt." *(1 Kings 12:28)*

"And the _____ brought him bread and meat in the morning, and bread and meat in the evening." *(1 Kings 17:6)*

"How long will you go _____ between two different opinions? If the LORD is God, follow him." *(1 Kings 18:21)*

"The LORD, he is _____; the LORD, he is God." *(1 Kings 18:39)*

Discuss

1. Jeroboam made golden calves so his people would not go to Jerusalem. What convenient substitutes for God do people create today? *1 Kings 12:26–30*

2. Baal was the god of rain, crops, and success. What do people trust for security and success today? *1 Kings 16:30–33; 17:1*

3. Elijah asked how long the people would limp between two opinions. Where are you trying to keep one foot in each world? *1 Kings 18:21*

Memory verse

"The LORD, he is God; the LORD, he is God."

1 Kings 18:39

Pray

Confess the places where you limp between two opinions. Name your Baal to God, and thank him that he is the living God who answers.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 31

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Kings 18:17–39 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (1 Kings 19 and 2 Kings 17:1–23).

Main points to land

1. In 931 BC the kingdom split into Israel in the north and Judah in the south. The north began with golden calves and never turned back (1 Kings 12:28).
2. Elijah's name means my God is the LORD. On Carmel God answered by fire, and the people confessed, The LORD, he is God (1 Kings 18:39).
3. Idols demand everything and cannot answer. The living God answers, and in Jesus he delivers us from the wrath to come (1 Kings 18:26–29, 38; 1 Thess. 1:9–10).

Answer key (Observe)

1. gods
2. ravens
3. limping
4. God

Questions people will ask

Why did Elijah kill the prophets of Baal? Should Christians do that to false teachers?
No. Israel was a nation under God's direct rule, and its covenant law treated a prophet who led people to other gods as a capital traitor (Deuteronomy 13:5). Like the conquest, that belonged to Israel's unique place in history. The church fights false teaching with the truth, never with the sword (2 Corinthians 10:4; John 18:36).

Closing prayer

Lord, you are God, and there is no other. Forgive us for our divided hearts and for the idols we trust for rain and success. Thank you that you answer, and that you answered us in Jesus. Turn our hearts back to you. Amen.